

CHAPTER 9

Build Something That Lives

Build something that lives on its own — in Cowork, no code

The move	What you do	Why it matters
Describe it	Tell Claude what to build and who it's for — in plain words	Purpose and audience drive a better first version than any layout sketch
Let it build	Watch Claude create a real, working version you can look at	The hard part — the actual building — is Claude's job, not yours
React	Tell Claude what's wrong in plain language: "bigger," "warmer," "move that up"	This is the whole skill, and you already have it
Get it live	"Set this up so I can send people the link" — Claude handles hosting and setup	A site on your screen is a draft; a site anyone can visit is real
Test it	Send it to one trusted person and watch what confuses them	You're too close to see it clearly; one real person shows you what's left

The Build, in One Breath

Describe what you want → let Claude build it → react in plain words → get it live → put it in front of a real person → fix what they trip on → repeat.

Getting It Live

A custom web address costs a little money each year and takes a few minutes to set up. Worth it when you're sure. Not ready? Ask Claude for the simplest free way to share a link first, and buy the address once you love the thing.

Chat, Cowork, and Code

Chat is where you start — quick questions, ideas, Deep Research. **Cowork** is for projects worth their own workspace — it's where you built everything here. **Code** (Claude Code) is the engine underneath Cowork, with a developer's full toolkit — where you go when a project outgrows a conversation. Same instinct in all three: describe, react, repeat.

The Mindset Shift

Everything before this, you open and use. This, you build and turn loose. It runs without you — greeting visitors and doing its job while you do something else. That's what "lives on its own" means, and you just made one.



*This reference card is a companion to Chapter 9 of Creating with Claude by Chris Thatcher.
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